a status code indicating the problem, such as `404 Not Found` or `400 Bad Request`. The most declarative way to do this with minimal APIs is to return an `IResult` instance.

All the endpoint handlers you've seen so far in this book have returned `void`, a `string`, or a plain old CLR object (POCO) such as `Person` or `Fruit`. There is one other type of object you can return from an endpoint: an `IResult` implementation.

In summary, the endpoint middleware handles each return type as follows:

- `void` or `Task`—The endpoint returns a `200` response with no body.
- `string` or `Task<string>`—The endpoint returns a `200` response with the string serialized to the body as `text/plain`.
- `IResult` or `Task<IResult>`—The endpoint executes the `IResult.ExecuteAsync` method. Depending on the implementation, this type can customize the response, returning any status code.
- `T` or `Task<T>`—All other types (such as POCO objects) are serialized to JSON and returned in the body of a `200` response as `application/json`.

The `IResult` implementations provide much of the flexibility in minimal APIs, as you'll see in section 5.3.1.